



Aeria Policy Document

1. Document Control / Header Information

Title

CRM - Decision - Making Process

Document Number / Code

CRM1019

Version / Revision Number

V25_01

Date of Issue / Effective Date

Sep 16, 2025

Review Date

Feb 1, 2026

Prepared By

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Approved By

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Amendment / Revision History

Date	Description of Change	Approved By
Sep 16, 2025	Initial release of the new document style	Dustin Wales
Date	[Description of change]	Person
Date	[Description of change]	Person

2. Purpose & Scope

Purpose

To establish structured decision -making protocols for RPAS operations. Effective decision -making ensures safe, timely, and informed choices that align with mission objectives, safety standards, and regulatory requirements.

Scope

Applies to all Aeria RPAS operational personnel, including Pilots in Command (PICs), Visual Observers (VOs), Operations Managers, subcontractors, and support personnel engaged in planning, execution, and debriefing of RPAS missions.

3. Definitions & References

Definitions

- Decision-Making: The cognitive process of evaluating information and selecting a course of action.
- Real-Time Decision Matrix: A structured framework for evaluating risk and options in dynamic scenarios.



- Collaborative Decision-Making: A process where PICs, VOs, and crew members contribute input to support effective outcomes.

References

- Aeria CRM Manual, Section: Decision-Making Process
- Aeria RPAS Operations Manual (General & Emergency Procedures)
- Transport Canada Advisory Circular 700-042, Appendix A

4. Policy Statement

Aeria Solutions requires all RPAS crew to apply structured decision-making processes during mission planning, execution, and post-mission review. Decisions must prioritize safety, comply with SOPs and CARs, and leverage input from all team members to ensure effective outcomes.

5. Procedures

Step-by-Step Actions

Pre-Mission (Planned Decisions):

- Use decision matrices and risk assessment tools during planning.
- Establish clear decision-making roles and criteria before operations.

During Mission (Real-Time Decisions):

- PIC makes final operational decisions, supported by VO and crew input.
- Apply structured tools such as decision matrices for complex or high-risk scenarios.
- Adjust mission plans as conditions evolve (weather, equipment, or airspace changes).

Post-Mission (Review Decisions):

- Review effectiveness of decisions in debrief.
- Document successes, failures, and lessons learned for training.

Roles & Responsibilities for Each Step

- PIC: Lead all mission-critical decisions; ensure safety and regulatory compliance.
- VO: Provide situational input, confirm observations, and challenge unsafe decisions using P.A.C.E. protocol.
- Operations Manager: Validate risk assessments and ensure decision-making frameworks are used in planning.





- Crew Members: Offer timely input, feedback, and observations to support collaborative decision-making.

Tools, Forms, or Checklists to be Used

- Decision Matrix Templates
- Risk Assessment Forms (Site Survey, CONOPS, SORA)
- Post-Mission Decision Review Log

Safety/Compliance/Quality Requirements

- Compliance with CARs Part IX regarding PIC authority and operational risk assessments.
- Adherence to Aeria SOPs for structured planning and risk-based decision processes.

Reporting or Escalation Processes

- Critical mission decisions documented in flight logs and debrief reports.
- Escalation to Accountable Executive if operational decisions compromise safety.

6. Roles & Responsibilities

Management

- Provide training in structured decision-making models and risk assessment tools.
- Ensure decision-making reviews are integrated into safety audits.

Supervisors

- Validate that risk-based frameworks (CONOPS, SORA) are applied.
- Lead structured reviews of decision-making in debriefs.

Staff

- Participate in decision-making processes by contributing accurate observations and feedback.
- Challenge unsafe decisions respectfully and escalate when required.

7. Monitoring, Compliance & Enforcement

How Compliance Will Be Monitored

- Field audits of decision-making practices during missions.
- Review of decision documentation in planning and debrief reports.
- Annual CRM training refreshers with scenario-based decision exercises.

Consequences for Non-Compliance

- Coaching or retraining for failure to use structured decision-making tools.
- Disciplinary measures for reckless or non-compliant decisions.

Reporting Obligations

- All high-risk or emergency-related decisions documented in operational records.
- Critical decision failures reported to the Accountable Executive.

8. Sign-Off & Acknowledgment

Approval Sign-Off

Role	Name	Signature	Date
Author	Dustin Wales		Sep 16, 2025
Reviewer	Person		Date
Approver	Person		Date



Employee Acknowledgment Section

I, Person , acknowledge that I have read, understood, and agree to abide by the terms and conditions outlined in this Policy & Procedure document.

Date: Date